

Custom Managed Portfolios

Aviso 5-year Bond Ladder (Taxable)

Quick facts

Asset class:

Canadian Bonds

Management style:
Income¹
Number of holdings:

10

Portfolio manager:

Aviso Wealth

Minimum investment:

\$100,000

Inception Date:

November 1, 2023

What does the strategy invest in?

This strategy will invest in high quality bonds, with a focus on capital preservation. The portfolio will consist of ten bonds, diversified across Federal, Provincial, and Corporate segments of the Canadian bond market, with a systematic maturity profile on an approximate six month rolling ladder. As holdings mature, the proceeds are reinvested into longer duration assets.

Bond ladders are a proven fixed income investment strategy that can reduce the impact of interest rate changes and minimize reinvestment risk to support a more predictable portfolio return profile. When interest rates rise, investors can take advantage of the higher rate by reinvesting the proceeds of the last matured bond. On the other hand, should rates fall, a large portion of the portfolio can still benefit from the original (higher) rates that applied when the initial investment was made. Staying disciplined and reinvesting the proceeds from maturing bonds can help investors to ride out interest rate fluctuations.

The **Taxable** bond ladder strategy will optimize tax-efficiency by prioritizing investments in bond issues that are trading at a material discount from par value where possible. While this results in a lower current income due to the lesser coupon payments, the tax treatment of the return is more efficient because a portion of that bond's return is now treated as capital gains and taxed at a lower rate than interest income. This results in a higher after-tax return for the investor.

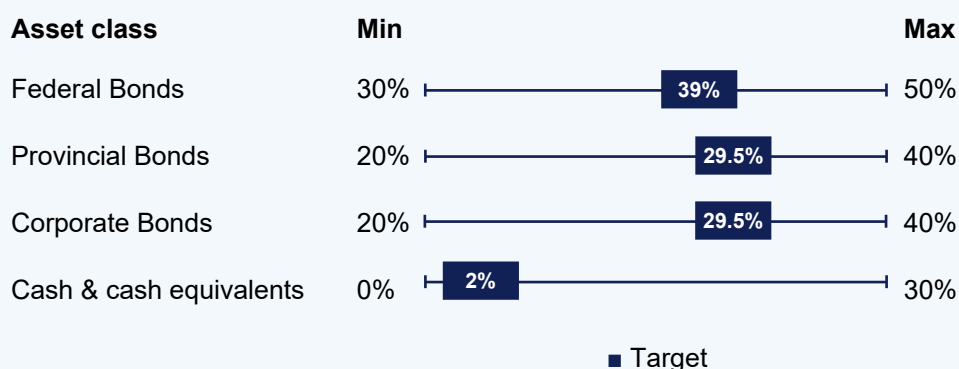
Current holdings

1. CDA HSG 1 SR 67 1.95% 15DEC25	9.8%	6. RBC 1.833% SR 31JUL28	9.8%
2. ONT PROV 2.40% 02JUN26	9.8%	7. CDA HSG SR 85 2.65% 15DEC28	9.8%
3. BMO 2.70% 09DEC26	9.8%	8. CDA GOVT 2.25% 01JUN29	9.8%
4. ALTA PROV 2.55% 01JUN27	9.8%	9. PROV OF ONT 1.55% 01NOV29	9.8%
5. CDA HSG SR 80 2.35% 15MAR28	9.8%	10. PSP CAP 2.05% NT S12 15 JAN30	9.8%

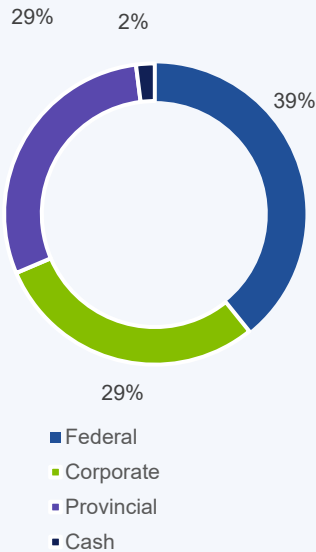
Portfolio attributes

Average yield to maturity (YTM)	Maturity weighted YTM	Average Current Yield (CY)	Maturity weighted CY	Average credit rating	Modified duration
2.9%	2.9%	2.3%	2.2%	AA+	2.56

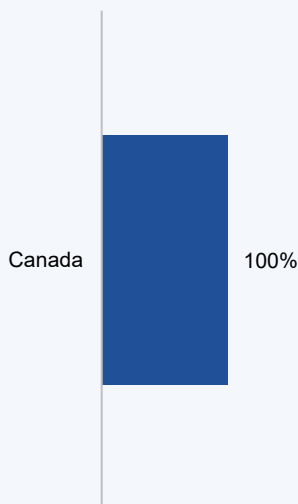
Target allocations



Sector breakdown



Geographic allocation



Quarterly commentary

Equities

North American Markets

Canadian equities advanced firmly during the second quarter of 2025, with the S&P/TSX Composite Index rising by 8.53%. A significant driver of this advance was a broad-based rally, with smaller-cap stocks notably outperforming their large-cap counterparts. The S&P/TSX SmallCap Index soared 11.75%, substantially ahead of the S&P/TSX 60 Index's gain of 7.59%. This expansion in market breadth reflected increasing investor risk appetite and optimism regarding Canada's economic prospects.

Domestic factors played a crucial role in bolstering Canadian equity performance during the quarter. The resumption of U.S.-Canada trade negotiations alleviated market uncertainties, while reduced political risk fostered a more favorable investment climate. This optimism was further supported by resilient consumer spending, robust corporate earnings in the technology sector, and a recovery in financials, particularly as higher interest rates supported bank profitability. Sector performance varied notably throughout the quarter. Information Technology led the way, buoyed by strong earnings results and continued enthusiasm surrounding artificial intelligence and digital transformation themes. Consumer Discretionary stocks benefited from a rebound in consumer spending, while Financials posted healthy gains amid rising interest margins and improved loan growth. Conversely, the Energy sector struggled with declining oil prices, ending the quarter near USD 65 per barrel. Health Care and Communication Services also lagged, weighed down by regulatory headwinds and shifting consumer preferences.

In Canadian dollar terms, domestic equities outpaced U.S. markets, as a strengthening loonie reduced the translation of foreign returns. This relative strength underlines the importance of currency considerations in global investing and highlights Canada's resilient performance amid a complex macroeconomic backdrop.

U.S. equities also delivered strong returns in Q2 2025. The S&P 500 Index advanced by 10.94%, marking one of its best quarterly performances in recent years. The technology-heavy NASDAQ Composite outpaced all major U.S. benchmarks with a remarkable 17.96% gain, driven by outsized gains in mega-cap technology firms and growth-oriented companies.

Investor optimism surrounding the Federal Reserve's potential pivot toward rate cuts later in the year, coupled with easing trade war tensions, fueled risk appetite. High-profile technology giants such as Broadcom and Oracle saw significant price appreciation, with Oracle benefiting from a landmark cloud services deal. The rally, however, was largely concentrated among a narrow group of stocks, raising concerns about market breadth and valuation sustainability.

Sector-wise, Information Technology, Communication Services, and Industrials led the charge, supported by robust earnings and momentum in areas like artificial intelligence, cloud computing, and infrastructure investment. Defensive sectors, including Real Estate and Health Care, underperformed due to rising interest rates and a shift toward more cyclical, growth-oriented investments. Energy stocks also struggled, reflecting a sharp drop in U.S. crude oil prices. The Dow Jones Industrial Average posted a more modest gain of 5.46%, reflecting its heavier exposure to traditional industrial and value-oriented stocks. Small-cap equities, as measured by the Russell 2000 Index, underperformed large-cap peers, advancing by 8.50%. The narrowing leadership among a handful of "Magnificent Seven" tech stocks remained a focal point for investors concerned about market concentration risks.

International Developed Markets

International developed equity markets delivered mixed results during the quarter, with notable performance dispersion across countries and sectors. The MSCI EAFE Index, which tracks developed markets outside North America, achieved a low double-digit gain, supported by declining bond yields and improving trade sentiment.

European equities benefited from a favorable macroeconomic backdrop, including falling inflation and fiscal stimulus measures. Countries such as Israel, Hong Kong, and Portugal stood out as top performers. Israel's robust technology sector staged a strong rebound, while Hong Kong's market rallied on expectations of increased policy support from mainland China. Portugal saw gains driven by strength in its banking and energy sectors.

Conversely, Denmark, France, and Switzerland lagged their developed market peers. Denmark faced challenges from underperformance in its pharmaceutical and renewable energy sectors, while France struggled with softness in luxury goods demand and weaker industrial output. Switzerland's defensive market profile and a strengthening Swiss franc weighed on equity performance, particularly for export-oriented companies.

European markets broadly benefited from investor optimism about improving economic conditions and the potential resolution of global trade tensions.

Additionally, easing bond yields provided a tailwind for equity valuations, encouraging risk-taking behavior.

Emerging Markets

Emerging market equities outperformed their developed market counterparts in Q2 2025, with the MSCI Emerging Markets Index climbing 11.99%. This strong showing reflected a combination of favorable macroeconomic trends, improving investor sentiment, and significant country-specific catalysts.

South Korea emerged as a top performer among emerging markets, driven by a rally in semiconductor and battery-related stocks. The global technology upcycle, coupled with strong demand for electric vehicle components, bolstered South Korea's equity market. Mexico also delivered robust returns, supported by steady economic growth, favorable nearshoring trends, and improving investor confidence.

Brazil's market gained on the back of rising commodity exports and signs of easing inflation, which increased the likelihood of interest rate cuts. These developments attracted inflows into Brazilian assets and lifted equity prices.

In contrast, some emerging markets faced headwinds during the quarter. China's equity market underperformed as the anticipated post-pandemic economic recovery lost momentum. Investor sentiment remained cautious amid concerns about slowing growth and ongoing regulatory pressures on key sectors. South Africa and Indonesia also posted weaker returns, reflecting domestic challenges such as energy shortages, currency volatility, and declining commodity prices.

Overall, emerging markets benefitted from a supportive global liquidity environment and a weakening U.S. dollar, which eased financial conditions for countries with significant external debt exposure. However, the wide dispersion of returns across countries highlighted the importance of careful country selection and risk management within the emerging markets universe.

Fixed Income

Global fixed income markets produced mixed results in Q2 2025, reflecting divergent economic conditions and monetary policy expectations across regions. Outside North America, the Bloomberg Global Aggregate ex-US Index advanced 7.3%, supported by sharp declines in bond yields across Europe and the United Kingdom. Softer inflation prints and dovish signals from central banks, including the European Central Bank and the Bank of England, contributed to a rally in

sovereign debt.

In the United States, U.S. Treasuries also gained, albeit to a lesser extent. The market responded to growing expectations that the Federal Reserve would pivot toward rate cuts in the latter half of the year. The two-year Treasury yield declined sharply, reflecting investors' conviction that monetary tightening had peaked. Longer-dated yields moved within a narrower range, balancing inflation concerns with strong demand for U.S. government debt.

In contrast, Canadian fixed income markets underperformed relative to global peers. The Bloomberg Canada Aggregate Index declined 0.7%, as the Bank of Canada's relatively hawkish stance pushed bond yields higher. The Canadian government yield curve steepened, with the two-year yield rising to approximately 2.59% and the ten-year yield climbing to around 3.27% by quarter-end.

Investment-grade corporate bonds delivered a modest positive return of 0.54%, supported by stable credit spreads and shorter durations. However, high-yield bonds suffered significant losses, with the Bloomberg Canada High Yield Bond Index plunging -4.74%. This stark underperformance reflected a combination of rising risk-free rates and widening credit spreads, particularly among lower-rated issuers.

Currencies

Currency markets experienced notable shifts during the quarter, as the U.S. dollar weakened against a broad basket of peers. The U.S. Dollar Index (DXY) registered its longest consecutive monthly decline since 2017, driven by diminished safe-haven demand and expectations that the Federal Reserve had reached the end of its tightening cycle.

The Canadian dollar emerged as a standout performer, appreciating by 5.41% versus the U.S. dollar. This strength was underpinned by Canada's robust commodity export profile, particularly in metals and agriculture, and the Bank of Canada's comparatively less dovish monetary policy stance.

Other major currencies displayed mixed performance. The euro, British pound, and New Zealand dollar faced headwinds from domestic growth concerns and tighter fiscal constraints. By contrast, the Mexican peso and Swiss franc recorded notable gains. The peso benefited from elevated local interest rates and solid economic fundamentals, while the Swiss franc attracted safe-haven flows amid geopolitical uncertainties and rising Swiss yields.

The U.S. dollar's retreat during Q2 2025 provided a tailwind for international equity and fixed income returns when translated into Canadian dollars, enhancing the appeal of global diversification.

Investment manager overview

The Aviso Investment Management team brings together top investment specialists and analysts, including four registered Portfolio Managers, eight CFA charter holders and more than 60 years of combined industry experience, to provide clients with a comprehensive range of professionally designed and managed financial products and solutions.

Investment philosophy

We adhere to a philosophy that encompasses the following principles:

- 1. Investment decisions are made in the best interests of our clients.
- 2. Investment decisions are made in accordance with the general level of risk appropriate for the specified mandate.
- 3. Investment decisions are made in accordance with defined prudent standards; and
- 4. Investment practices adhere to the principles of quality (or safety) of the investment and overall risk diversification.

Investment process and risk controls

The primary investment objective of the strategy is to generate a steady stream of high-quality income (in Canadian dollars) and to minimize trading cost. This strategy will follow a disciplined and systematic laddered investment strategy and will comprise only of high-quality bond holdings.

Credit Rating – the strategy will be invested in high quality bonds, with a credit rating minimum of S&P/Moody’s/Fitch/DBRS credit rating of A-/A3/A-/A(low). Any of the holdings that are downgraded below this threshold will be sold and replaced with a similar maturing bond with the same intended characteristic.

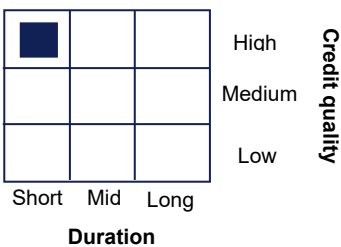
Maturity – the strategy will be constructed on a six-month ladder T + 5 year rolling basis.

Individual Security Holding Limits – the bond ladder is equally divided between all of the holdings; this will result in rolling consistent maturity interval; targeted size is 10% for each security.

Issuer – There are no issuer restrictions within the federal and provincial bond holdings provided that other criteria for ownership have been met; there can only be one corporate issuer per corporate bond holding within the portfolio at a given time.

Term limits – the maximum term to maturity at the time of purchase is 5.5 years; this will be the term of the last laddered issue, while providing a buffer if selection is limited.

Fixed income style²



About Aviso Wealth

Aviso Wealth is part of Aviso, one of Canada’s largest independent wealth management firms. Owned by the credit unions, we serve hundreds of thousands of investors at credit unions across Canada.

With approximately \$130 billion of assets under administration and management, Aviso has the resources to bring the best products and services to credit unions and their members. Invest with confidence, with your credit union and Aviso.

- Nearly 30 years as the wealth management provider to credit unions across Canada
- One of Canada’s largest independent wealth management firms
- Parent company of Aviso Wealth, NEI Investments, and Qtrade
- Owned by Canada’s credit unions and Desjardins



¹ Income: To generate a steady stream of income.

² Duration measures the sensitivity of the fixed income investments to interest rate changes measured in years. In general, the longer the duration, the more sensitive the investment will be to interest rates changes. Credit quality measures the underlying issuer's ability to repay their debt.

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